

Google Earth fights Typhoid

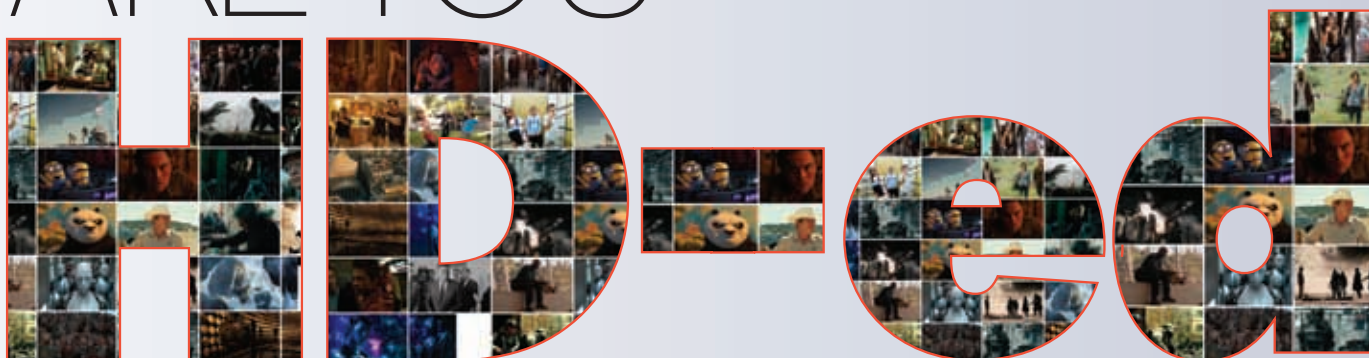
Google Earth helps researchers to reveal Typhoid outbreak secrets in places where health workers are restricted
<http://bit.ly/pNYqMo>

LG to catch up on rivals

LG ELECTRONICS have announced the arrivals of ultra high speed Smartphone base on 4G wireless technology

HD Media Players Test

ARE YOU



Get ready to abate your thirst for HD content. We have an HD media player for each one of you, read on to find which one you should pick.

YET?

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An HD media player upscales your media content to 1080p but while doing so it doesn't add any detail to the video, rather it works to remove the artifacts that become visible when the image is resized.

Ultra-compact

Four players fought it out in this category, one each from Amkette, ASUS, Buffalo and iOmega.

Build and design

Cased with an aluminum exterior, the iOmega Screenplay TV Link MX player completely stood out in terms of build quality, whilst Amekette Flash TV HD and ASUS O! Play Mini both have very plasticky build quality and felt hollow. The Amkette Flash TV HD has a unique disc shaped form factor. The Buffalo Link Theatre has a good sturdy build but is encased with a glossy exterior which makes it smudge and scratch prone.

User interface

The UI on the O! Play Mini is very straightforward and simple to use, but looks outdated. Disappointingly the player lacks a search option. The UI on the iOmega is no different, simple but boring. The iOmega further fails to automatically compile all the data under each media, lacks jump to next track option for music and the "Go To" feature that allows you to jump to a specific part of the video. On the other hand, the Amkette Flash TV HD despite having a simple UI, it automatically compiles all the media in each section and has a search option. The Buffalo

Link Theatre has the least visually appealing UI. This makes it difficult to use but it still gives a zippy performance.

Remote

All the media players come with very basic remotes. The Amkette media player's remote is sleek and compact but has a plasticky build, the cost cutting is very evident. The iOmega has the best remote of the lot in terms of build quality and key response. The remote bundled with Buffalo Link Theatre has a decent built quality and a good key response.

we don't have any complaints, at this price point it's really amazing how these compact players deliver good upscaling.

Winner

With decent upscaling performance, a plethora of format support, while being easy on your pocket we award Amekette Flash TV HD the best buy.

Mid-range

There were seven contenders in this price bracket. We received four players from ASUS and one each from iOmega, Seagate and WD.

Performance

The Amkette and iOmega delivered poor performance with darker scenes, while the ASUS did comparatively better. Amkette and iOmega managed to give crisp and sharp images while ASUS lagged behind. The Buffalo managed to deliver high quality upscaling. Overall

Build and design

ASUS O! Play HDP R1 and ASUS O! Play Air have an almost identical design, a book shaped form factor. Both the players have a sturdy build quality. Both have a glossy side strip that is prone to fingerprints and scratches. The ASUS HD 2 has a firm build but has a very odd design with a glossy sheet on the top,



Amkette Flash TV HD